

You're Not Crazy — You're Trauma Bonded

Understanding Why Leaving Feels Impossible

"The truth will set you free." — John 8:32

KEY CONCEPTS

1 What is a trauma bond?

Intermittent reinforcement — unpredictable cycles of pain and reward — creates a neurological bond that mimics addiction. The highs feel higher because of the lows. This is chemistry, not character failure.

2 Why 'just leave' doesn't work

The same part of your brain that drives addiction is activated when you try to leave a narcissistic relationship. Willpower alone can't override your nervous system. You need tools — not more strength.

3 God sees this differently

Scripture never says 'just try harder.' Jesus met people in their pain, not above it. Your longing for the love you were created for is holy. The wound is real. And healing is possible.

THIS WEEK'S PRACTICE

Name the bond: Write down one way your abuser made you feel chosen, and one way they made you feel worthless. Notice how those two things alternated. That alternation is the hook.

YOUR REFLECTION

'I am trauma bonded, not broken. My longing for love is not a flaw — it's a sign I was made for something better.'

YOUR NOTES & JOURNAL SPACE

WANT TO GO DEEPER?

In the full Reclaim Your Self community at \$27/month, we do an entire module on trauma bonding with an interactive tool that maps your specific cycle — so you can finally see the pattern clearly and begin to break it.

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